

OTO 2 · ASK MARINA AI™

Never Get Stuck Alone Again.

Your written troubleshooting companion — the 20 most common mistakes, diagnosed and fixed, plus batch-specific adjustments and a one-page emergency reference for the moment something goes wrong.

-  The 20 most common mistakes, diagnosed and fixed
-  Batch-specific adjustment guide by flavor and quantity
-  A one-page emergency quick-reference card
-  Your first-week personal check-in

Contents

Read Section 1 once end to end so you recognize each mistake on sight, then keep Section 3's quick-reference card open while you work.

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Introduction · Why a shopping list can't answer a question

"Bonus 4 tells you what to buy. This tells you what to do the moment something goes wrong with what you bought."

Most people don't quit this training because the recipes are bad. They quit because they hit one confusing moment — chocolate seizing, shells that won't release, a filling that's too wet — late at night, with no one to ask, and "just tonight" turns into never opening the training again.

This guide is built exactly like a conversation: find your problem below, read the diagnosis, apply the fix. It covers the twenty situations that come up again and again, organized so you can scan to your exact problem in seconds.

✓ **How to use this.** Don't read it cover to cover under pressure. Skim Section 1 once now, calmly, so you recognize each mistake by name. Then when something goes wrong mid-batch, you'll already know which page to open.

The 20 Most Common Mistakes

Diagnosed and fixed, one at a time.

Chocolate & tempering

You: My chocolate seized and turned into a grainy clump.

Marina: A drop of water got into it. There's no saving the seized batch for shells — but you can rescue it as filling by adding a small splash of warm cream, one teaspoon at a time, stirring until smooth. For next time: dry every bowl and tool completely before it touches chocolate.

You: My shells won't release from the mold.

Marina: The chocolate wasn't tempered cold enough before unmolding, or the mold wasn't cold when you poured. Pop the whole mold in the fridge for 10 more minutes, then try again by flexing the mold gently — never pry with a tool.

You: My shells have white streaks (bloom).

Marina: Temperature swings during cooling. Cosmetic only — still safe and tasty. To prevent it, cool at a steady room temperature away from drafts and the fridge door.

You: My chocolate is too thick to coat the mold evenly.

Marina: It's cooled too much while working. Gently rewarm over a double boiler for 10-15 seconds, stirring, then continue.

You: My shells are too thin and crack easily.

Marina: Not enough chocolate was used per cavity, or it was poured and drained too quickly. Use a slightly thicker first coat and let it set for a few extra seconds before draining excess.

Filling & assembly

You: My filling is too wet and leaks through the seam.

Marina: Too much liquid relative to powder in your filling mix. Add milk powder or cocoa a teaspoon at a time until it holds its shape when pressed, then re-seal with a fresh dab of melted chocolate.

You: My filling is too dry and crumbly.

Marina: Too much powder, not enough liquid or fat. Add a few drops of warm cream or melted cocoa butter until it comes together without crumbling.

You: The two shell halves won't seal together cleanly.

Marina: The rims weren't warm enough to fuse. Touch each rim briefly to a warm pan or lighter warmed surface for one second before pressing halves together.

You: My capsule collapsed when I picked it up.

Marina: The shell was too thin at that spot (see the cracking fix above), or it was handled before it was fully set. Give shells a full 10 extra minutes in the fridge before handling.

You: There's an air bubble visible in my shell.

Marina: Air got trapped during pouring. Tap the filled mold firmly on the counter 3-4 times immediately after pouring, before it starts to set.

Flavor & consistency

You: My cappuccino flavor tastes flat.

Marina: Instant coffee needs to be finely ground or dissolved, not left as coarse granules. Grind it finer or dissolve a small amount in the tiniest splash of hot water first, then mix into the filling.

You: My filling separates or looks oily.

Marina: Fat and dry ingredients weren't fully emulsified. Mix longer and at a slightly warmer temperature — cocoa butter needs real mixing time to bind evenly.

You: Two different flavor batches taste inconsistent from batch to batch.

Marina: Ingredient measuring is off, usually because it's done by volume instead of weight. Switch to a kitchen scale for filling ingredients — it's the single biggest consistency fix.

Storage & shelf life

You: My finished capsules went soft after a day.

Marina: Stored somewhere too warm, or exposed to humidity. Keep finished capsules in a cool, dry spot, ideally under 20°C (68°F), away from direct sun.

You: My capsules developed condensation inside the wrap.

Marina: They were wrapped while still slightly warm. Let capsules cool completely to room temperature — at least 30 minutes — before individually wrapping.

Timing & batching

You: I'm running out of time before an order is due.

Marina: Tempering and setting time is the part people underestimate. Build in at least 2 hours of buffer beyond your "working time" for cooling and setting — see the batch guide in Section 2 for exact timing by batch size.

You: My whole batch set unevenly — some capsules firm, some still soft.

Marina: Uneven fridge temperature across shelves. Rotate the tray to the coldest, most even shelf (usually the middle-back) and avoid the door.

Customer-facing problems

You: A customer says their capsule arrived melted.

Marina: Shipping or delivery exposure to heat. Offer a same-day replacement if it's a local delivery — it protects the relationship and rarely happens twice once you adjust delivery timing.

You: A customer says the capsule didn't "melt" properly in their milk.

Marina: The shell was too thick, or the milk wasn't hot enough (needs to be steaming, not just warm). Remind customers in your serving card (Bonus 5) to use hot, not warm, milk.

SECTION 2 OF 4

Batch-Specific Adjustment Guide

How your technique needs to change as batch size or flavor changes.

SITUATION	ADJUSTMENT
Batch of 6-12	Standard timing from the core training applies directly — no adjustment needed.
Batch of 25+	Temper chocolate in two smaller rounds instead of one large one — a single large batch of tempered chocolate cools unevenly before you finish pouring all cavities.
Batch of 50+	Work in relays: pour and set one tray while filling the next. Keep a second bowl of tempered chocolate ready so the first doesn't over-cool while you work.
Dark chocolate flavors	Temper 1-2°C cooler than milk or white chocolate — dark chocolate sets faster and is less forgiving of overheating.
White chocolate flavors	Extra sensitive to heat — never exceed the low end of your tempering range, and work quickly once melted.
Fruit-filled flavors	Freeze-dried fruit adds dryness — increase your filling's liquid slightly compared to the standard recipe.
Humid climate	Shorten cooling time expectations and consider a dehumidifier or air conditioning in your workspace — humidity is the #1 cause of bloom and soft shells.

Emergency Quick-Reference Card

Print or screenshot this one page. Everything else in this guide, compressed.



Mid-batch emergency lookup

Chocolate seized → rescue as filling with warm cream, don't use for shells

Shells won't release → 10 more minutes in the fridge, flex don't pry

Filling too wet → add powder a teaspoon at a time

Filling too dry → add warm cream a few drops at a time

Won't seal → warm rims 1 second before pressing together

Air bubble → tap mold firmly right after pouring, next time

Flat coffee flavor → dissolve or grind finer next batch

Still stuck?

See Section 1

Claim your first-week check-in

If you're one of the first 100 buyers of this bonus, this is yours.



How to claim it

Reply to your purchase confirmation any time in your first 7 days with how your first batch went

Get one personal note back on what to adjust, within 72 hours

Offer disappears once spot 100 fills



You're covered. Between the 20 fixes in Section 1 and the quick-reference card in Section 3, you now have an answer ready for the moment before it happens.

You're never stuck alone again.

Every common mistake, diagnosed and fixed, plus a one-page card for the moment you need it fastest.



Keep this handy

Screenshot Section 3's quick-reference card — it's built to live on your phone, not in a drawer.

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